CHAPTER FOUR

RESULTS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of data gathered for this study, with the aim of providing empirical evidence to answer the research questions and test the hypotheses formulated in Chapter Three. The analysis is organized to enhance clarity and coherence, beginning with the presentation of the socio-demographic characteristics of the respondents. This includes details such as gender, age, marital status, educational qualifications, job positions, length of service, and experiences of verbal microaggressions, offering a background to better understand the composition of the study sample.

4.2 Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

This section presents the socio-demographic characteristics of the 239 non-academic staff who participated in the study. Understanding these characteristics helps to provide context for interpreting the results that follow. The demographic information covers variables such as gender, age, marital status, educational qualification, job position or role within the organization, length of service in the current organization, and whether respondents have experienced or witnessed verbal microaggressions in the workplace.

The data are summarized in tables showing the frequency and percentage distribution of respondents across each category. These tables help illustrate the composition of the sample and highlight patterns that may be relevant when discussing the results of the study.

Table 4.1: Socio-Demographic Characteristics of Respondents

Demographic Variables	Frequency	Percent
Gender		
Male	113	47.3
Female	126	52.7
Total	239	100.0
Age		
18-24 years	69	28.9
25-34 years	90	37.7
35-44 years	50	20.9
45-54 years	24	10.0
55 years and above	6	2.5
Total	239	100.0
Marital Status		
Single	125	52.3
Married	89	37.2
Divorced/Separated	16	6.7
Widowed	9	3.8
Total	239	100.0
Educational Qualification		
High School Diploma	20	8.4
Bachelor's degree	172	72.0
Doctorate (Ph.D)	44	18.4
Others	3	1.3
Total	239	100.0
Job Position		
Entry-level staff	91	38.1
Mid-level staff	80	33.5
Senior-level staff	56	23.4
Management/Executive	12	5.0
Total	239	100.0
Length of Service in Current Organization		
Less than a year	27	11.3
1-3 years	78	32.6
4-6 years	61	25.5
7-10 years	48	20.1
More than 10 years	25	10.5
Total	239	100.0
Experience of Verbal Microaggressions		
Yes	151	63.2
No	88	36.8
Total	239	100.0

The study sample of 239 respondents reveals a relatively balanced gender distribution, with 47.3% male and 52.7% female respondents. Although the sample shows a slight female majority, the gender distribution is generally even, reflecting a diverse participant base. This balance ensures that the findings are likely representative of both genders in the context of the study.

Age-wise, the majority of respondents fall within the 25-34 years range (37.7%), followed by those aged 18-24 years (28.9%). Together, these two age groups make up 66.4% of the sample, indicating that the study predominantly represents a younger workforce, likely in the early to middle stages of their careers. Smaller proportions of the sample are aged 35-44 years (20.9%), 45-54 years (10.0%), and 55 years and above (2.5%), reflecting a more youthful workforce overall.

In terms of marital status, the sample is predominantly single, with 52.3% of respondents reporting this status, followed by 37.2% who are married. The remaining respondents are either divorced/separated (6.7%) or widowed (3.8%), suggesting that the workforce in this study is largely unmarried. This could be reflective of the younger age distribution, as marital status often correlates with age.

Regarding educational qualifications, the respondents are well-educated, with 72.0% holding a Bachelor's degree. A further 18.4% have obtained a Doctorate (Ph.D.), while 8.4% possess only a high school diploma, and 1.3% have other qualifications. This indicates that the majority of the participants are highly educated, with most holding at least a bachelor's degree, suggesting that the sample may represent individuals with significant educational credentials in the workforce.

When considering the job positions of the respondents, the sample is mainly composed of entry-level (38.1%) and mid-level (33.5%) staff. A smaller portion, 23.4%, hold senior-level positions, and just 5.0% occupy management or executive roles. This shows that the study largely reflects individuals in the lower to middle tiers of their organizations, providing insights into the challenges faced by employees who are not in higher management roles.

In terms of length of service, the majority of respondents have worked in their current organization for 1-3 years (32.6%). This is followed by those who have been employed for 4-6 years (25.5%),

and 7-10 years (20.1%). About 11.3% of respondents have been employed for less than a year, while 10.5% have worked for more than 10 years. This suggests that the sample includes both newer employees as well as those with moderate experience, providing a well-rounded perspective on the workforce.

Finally, the experience of verbal microaggressions is notable, with 63.2% of respondents reporting that they have experienced or witnessed such incidents in the workplace. This indicates that microaggressions are a significant concern within the sample, suggesting that verbal harassment is a prevalent issue that needs attention in the workplace.

Overall, the sample reflects a young, educated, predominantly unmarried workforce with moderate experience in their organizations. The study highlights important issues related to workplace microaggressions, which seem to be a common challenge for the participants, especially for those in entry- and mid-level positions. This demographic provides valuable insights into how such issues might impact the daily working experience of non-academic staff, particularly those with relatively less experience and in lower organizational roles.

4.3 Descriptive Analysis of Key Study Variables

The descriptive statistics of the study variables are presented to give insight into the tendencies of respondents regarding verbal aggression and job satisfaction. The mean score indicates the average response, while the standard deviation shows the degree of variability among the responses.

Table 4.2: Descriptive Statistics of Verbal Aggression Items

Item	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
I tell my friends openly when I disagree with them.	239	3.44	1.29
I often find myself disagreeing with people.	239	3.48	1.24
When people annoy me, I may tell them what I think of them.	239	3.34	1.26
I can’t help getting into arguments when people disagree with me.	239	3.32	1.28

My friends say that I'm somewhat argumentative.	239	3.40	1.24

Interpretation: Table 4.2 shows that respondents generally scored moderately high across the verbal aggression items, with mean scores ranging from 3.32 to 3.48 on a scale of 1 to 5. This suggests that the non-academic staff in the sample often perceive themselves as somewhat argumentative and likely to disagree openly with others. The standard deviations (around 1.24–1.29) indicate a fair amount of variability in responses.

Table 4.3: Descriptive Statistics of Job Satisfaction Items

Item	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
I am satisfied with the nature of the work that I do.	239	3.23	1.24
I feel valued and appreciated by my organization.	239	3.15	1.29
I am satisfied with the level of support I receive from my supervisors.	239	3.17	1.25
I believe that my contributions are recognized and rewarded appropriately.	239	3.09	1.23
I am satisfied with the opportunities for career advancement in my organization.	239	3.12	1.26
Overall, I am satisfied with my current job.	239	3.20	1.27

Interpretation: Table 4.3 reveals that the average level of job satisfaction among respondents is slightly above the midpoint of the scale, with mean scores ranging from 3.09 to 3.23. This suggests a moderate level of satisfaction with various aspects of their jobs, although there is room for improvement. The standard deviations (around 1.23–1.29) again show a fair amount of diversity in how respondents perceive their work environment.

4.4 Test of Hypotheses

4.4.1 Test of Hypothesis One

The first hypothesis stated that "there is a significant relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction among non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University." To test this hypothesis, a Pearson product-moment correlation analysis was carried out between verbal aggression and job satisfaction scores of the respondents.

Table 4.4: Correlation between Verbal Aggression and Job Satisfaction

Correlations

		VERBALAGGRESSION	JOBSATISFACTION
VERBALAGGRESSION	Pearson Correlation	1	-.814**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.000
	N	239	239
JOBSATISFACTION	Pearson Correlation	-.814**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	
	N	239	239

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

As presented in Table 4.4, the result revealed a strong and significant negative correlation between verbal aggression and job satisfaction ($r = -0.814$, $p < 0.01$). This implies that higher levels of verbal aggression are associated with lower levels of job satisfaction among non-academic staff. The negative correlation coefficient indicates that as experiences of verbal aggression increase, job satisfaction tends to decrease correspondingly.

Based on this finding, the hypothesis is accepted, confirming that verbal microaggressions have a significant and inverse relationship with job satisfaction in the studied population.

4.4.2 Test of Hypothesis Two

The second hypothesis stated that "non-academic staff who experience higher levels of verbal microaggressions will report significantly lower levels of job satisfaction." To test this hypothesis, respondents were grouped based on whether they reported having experienced or witnessed verbal microaggressions (Yes or No). An independent samples t-test was then conducted to compare the mean job satisfaction scores of the two groups.

Table 4.5: Group Statistics table

Group Statistics

	Experienced_Microaggressions	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
JOBSATISFACTION	Yes	151	2.7837	.46380	.03774
	No	88	3.7405	.46791	.04988

As shown in the Group Statistics table, staff who had experienced or witnessed microaggressions (N = 151) reported a lower mean job satisfaction score (M = 2.78, SD = 0.46) compared to those who had not (N = 88; M = 3.74, SD = 0.47). The Independent Samples Test indicated that this difference was statistically significant, $t(237) = -15.33$, $p < 0.05$. The mean difference of -0.96 suggests that those who experienced or witnessed microaggressions felt notably less satisfied with their jobs.

Table 4.6: Independent Samples Test

Independent Samples Test

		Levene's Test for Equality of Variances		t-test for Equality of Means						
		F	Sig.	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	Std. Error Difference	95% Confidence Interval of the Difference	
									Lower	Upper
JOBSATISFACTION	Equal variances assumed	.665	.415	-15.333	237	.000	-.95687	.06240	-1.07980	-.83393
	Equal variances not assumed			-15.298	180.778	.000	-.95687	.06255	-1.08029	-.83344

Based on this result, the second hypothesis is **supported**, confirming that exposure to verbal microaggressions is associated with lower job satisfaction among non-academic staff.

4.4.3 Test of Hypothesis Three

The third hypothesis stated that "there is a significant difference in job satisfaction levels between male and female non-academic staff exposed to verbal microaggressions at Olabisi Onabanjo University." An independent samples t-test was conducted to compare the job satisfaction scores between male and female respondents who reported having experienced or witnessed microaggressions.

Table 4.7: Group Statistics table

Group Statistics

	Gender	N	Mean	Std. Deviation	Std. Error Mean
JOBSATISFACTION	Male	113	3.2109	.62123	.05844
	Female	126	3.0688	.67996	.06058

As shown in the Group Statistics table, male respondents (N = 113) had a slightly higher mean job satisfaction score (M = 3.21, SD = 0.62) compared to female respondents (N = 126; M = 3.07, SD = 0.68). The result from the Independent Samples Test indicated that this difference was not statistically significant, $t(237) = 1.68$, $p = 0.094$ ($p > 0.05$).

Table 4.8: Independent Samples Test

Independent Samples Test

	Levene's Test for Equality of Variances		t-test for Equality of Means						
	F	Sig.	t	df	Sig. (2-tailed)	Mean Difference	Std. Error Difference	95% Confidence Interval of the Difference	
								Lower	Upper

JOBSATISFACTION	Equal variances assumed	2.087	.150	1.680	237	.094	.14213	.08459	-.02450	.30877
	Equal variances not assumed			1.689	236.914	.093	.14213	.08417	-.02369	.30795

Therefore, the hypothesis is not supported, as there is no significant difference in job satisfaction between male and female respondents who have experienced verbal microaggressions.

CHAPTER FIVE

DISCUSSION, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

5.1 Discussion of Findings

This study aimed to explore the relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction among non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University. The results of the three hypotheses tested provide valuable insights into the effects of verbal aggression and gender differences on job satisfaction.

Hypothesis One: The first hypothesis proposed that "there is a significant relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction among non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University." The Pearson correlation revealed a strong, significant negative relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction ($r = -0.814$, $p < 0.01$). This indicates that as experiences of verbal microaggressions increase, job satisfaction decreases significantly. This result supports previous studies that have found a negative impact of workplace aggression on

employee well-being and satisfaction. It suggests that non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University who experience higher levels of verbal microaggressions are likely to report lower levels of job satisfaction, highlighting the importance of addressing microaggressions in the workplace to improve staff morale.

Hypothesis Two: The second hypothesis stated that "non-academic staff who experience higher levels of verbal microaggressions will report significantly lower levels of job satisfaction." The independent samples t-test supported this hypothesis, with staff who reported experiencing microaggressions having a significantly lower mean job satisfaction score ($M = 2.78$) compared to those who did not experience microaggressions ($M = 3.74$), $t(237) = -15.33$, $p < 0.05$. This result provides further evidence that verbal microaggressions have a detrimental effect on job satisfaction, consistent with the findings of similar studies in other work environments. It suggests that addressing microaggressions within the workplace could improve job satisfaction, particularly for those who are affected by such behaviors.

Hypothesis Three: The third hypothesis proposed that "there is a significant difference in job satisfaction levels between male and female non-academic staff exposed to verbal microaggressions." However, the results of the independent samples t-test indicated that there was no significant difference in job satisfaction between male and female staff exposed to verbal microaggressions ($t(237) = 1.68$, $p = 0.094$). Although males reported slightly higher mean job satisfaction scores than females, this difference was not statistically significant. This finding suggests that, in this sample, gender did not significantly influence how verbal microaggressions affected job satisfaction. This contrasts with some studies that have found gender differences in the impact of workplace aggression, suggesting that other factors, such as the nature or frequency of microaggressions, may play a more significant role in determining the effects on job satisfaction.

Overall Implications: The findings from this study underscore the significant role that verbal microaggressions play in shaping job satisfaction. The strong negative relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction points to the need for organizations to adopt strategies to reduce workplace aggression. These could include training programs to raise awareness of microaggressions, clear reporting mechanisms, and creating a supportive work environment where employees feel safe and valued.

Additionally, while gender did not significantly affect job satisfaction in this study, it may still be an important factor in different work environments or organizational contexts. Future research could explore other moderating factors, such as cultural differences, organizational policies, or individual coping mechanisms, to further understand how microaggressions influence job satisfaction.

5.2 Conclusion

This study set out to examine the impact of verbal microaggressions on job satisfaction among non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University. The findings indicate that verbal microaggressions significantly affect job satisfaction, with staff who experience higher levels of verbal aggression reporting lower job satisfaction. The results of the first and second hypotheses support the conclusion that microaggressions have a detrimental impact on the well-being of employees in the university setting.

The correlation analysis revealed a strong negative relationship between verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction, highlighting that as the level of verbal aggression increases, job satisfaction decreases. Furthermore, the independent samples t-test results confirmed that staff who experienced verbal microaggressions reported significantly lower job satisfaction compared to

those who did not. However, the third hypothesis, which tested for gender differences, did not find any significant difference in job satisfaction between male and female respondents, suggesting that both genders are equally affected by verbal microaggressions in this context.

In conclusion, this study emphasizes the need for universities to take proactive steps in addressing microaggressions within the workplace. Creating a more supportive and inclusive work environment could help enhance job satisfaction and overall staff well-being.

5.3 Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, the following recommendations are made to improve job satisfaction among non-academic staff at Olabisi Onabanjo University and to address the issue of verbal microaggressions in the workplace:

1. **Organizational Training and Awareness Programs**: It is recommended that the university implement training programs aimed at raising awareness about verbal microaggressions. These programs should focus on educating staff and management about the subtle nature of microaggressions, their impact on individuals, and the importance of fostering a respectful and inclusive work environment. By equipping employees with the skills to identify and handle microaggressions, the university can create a more supportive atmosphere.

2. **Clear Reporting Mechanisms for Microaggressions**: The university should establish a clear, confidential, and accessible reporting system for employees to report any incidents of microaggressions they experience or witness. Staff should feel safe and assured that their complaints will be taken seriously and handled appropriately. A transparent process will

encourage more employees to come forward, helping to reduce the prevalence of microaggressions.

3. **Promotion of a Positive Organizational Culture**: A culture of respect, inclusion, and appreciation should be promoted at all levels of the university. This includes creating opportunities for open dialogue between staff and management, where employees can express concerns without fear of retaliation. Regular workshops or discussions on fostering an inclusive workplace could help reinforce positive behaviors and reduce negative interactions.

4. **Regular Evaluation of Employee Well-being**: The university should implement regular employee satisfaction surveys to gauge staff well-being and identify any emerging issues related to verbal microaggressions and job satisfaction. These surveys can provide valuable data to inform decisions and interventions aimed at improving the work environment.

5. **Further Research on Workplace Microaggressions**: Future studies could explore the long-term effects of verbal microaggressions on employee productivity, mental health, and career progression. It would also be beneficial to examine the impact of organizational policies and workplace culture on the prevalence of microaggressions. Research on how different types of microaggressions affect various demographic groups, such as gender, age, and job roles, could further enhance the understanding of this issue.